application standalone. Spring Boot comes bundled with a preconfigured Tomcat server, but it's possible to replace it with Undertow, Jetty, or Netty.

Having solved the server dependency problem, we need to change how we package the application accordingly. In the JVM ecosystem, cloud native applications are packaged as JAR artifacts. Since they are self-contained, they can run as standalone Java applications with no external dependency apart from the JVM. Spring Boot is flexible enough to allow both JAR and WAR types of packaging. Still, for cloud native applications, you'll want to use self-contained JARs, also called *fat-JARs* or *uber-JARs*, since they contain the application itself, the dependencies, and the embedded server. Figure 3.3 compares the traditional and cloud native ways of packaging and running web applications.

